

Wedding Budget Planner — quick-start guide

Open `Wedding-Budget-Planner.xlsx` in Excel, or upload it to Google Drive and open it with Google Sheets. Only fill in the yellow cells.

Set up in 15 minutes

1. **Basics:** guests, total budget, wedding date, what you have saved and what you can save per month.
2. **Items:** the sample items are placeholders. Replace the amounts with the prices from your quotes, delete what you don't need, add your own.
3. **Per guest or flat fee:** food, drinks, cocktail hour, cake and favors cost per person. Venue, photographer, music, attire and rings are flat fees.
4. **Deposits:** the percentage and timing are in the quote, for example "30 % at booking, nine months before". Money you have already transferred goes under "Already paid".
5. **Read the result:** cost per guest, how many guests fit your budget, and the monthly savings that cover every payment.

Guest list first

Flat fees stay the same whether 60 or 120 guests come. Food and drinks grow with every person. The planner shows what each extra guest costs and how many fewer guests would bring you back within budget.

Deposits and savings

Many vendors want a deposit to hold your date. The money does not have to be ready on the wedding day, but step by step. The monthly savings in the planner are worked out so that **every** payment is covered on time. The sheet "Payment Plan" shows month by month what is due. Red means: with your monthly savings you are short at that point.

Tip: a separate savings account for the wedding, filled by a standing order right after payday.

Buffer

Plan about ten percent as its own item. Something always comes up: more drinks, dress alterations, tips, extra transport.

Good to know

The planner does not know your quotes and ignores interest. The sample amounts are placeholders, not average prices. Works with any currency.

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